

▼ NELSON MANDELA

South African activist and politician Nelson Mandela challenged the system of apartheid and was imprisoned for 27 years (see p.203). After his release in 1990, he helped create a system where every citizen could vote, regardless of their skin color. Mandela was elected as the country's first Black president in 1994.



◀ CHALLENGES OF URBANIZATION

Since gaining independence, countries in Africa have seen a rise in urbanization—the large-scale movement of people from villages to cities and towns. This has created multiple challenges such as a lack of proper housing facilities leading to an increase in slum areas, traffic on roads, and widespread pollution.



THE ENVIRONMENT ▶

In 1977, Kenyan environmentalist and feminist Wangari Maathai started the Green Belt Movement, empowering women in the villages of Kenya to plant trees to counter deforestation as well as provide a source of food and fuel. By the early 21st century, more than 30 million trees had been planted. Maathai's efforts won her the Nobel Peace Prize in 2004.



◀ 2010 FIFA WORLD CUP

The FIFA World Cup is one of the most widely watched sporting events in the world. Nelson Mandela campaigned to have South Africa as the host country for 2010, which was eventually granted, making South Africa the first African nation to host the tournament. Thousands of people came out to support their national team.

CHILD IN TIME

Born in 1991, Thandiwe Chama is a young activist from Zambia. She has campaigned for better educational facilities in Zambia, as well as for the welfare of people suffering from diseases such as HIV/AIDS. Chama was awarded the International Children's Peace Prize in 2007.

